Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Drew Conclusions

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster

Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment.

- Friendly rival of **Paige Turner**.
- Has reviewed **Vincent Van Faux**, **Dada DiCapo**, **Al Baster**, and **Elle Loominate**.
- **Elon Mosaic** remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Drew Conclusions. I review art professionally. My expression is not a verdict, but I recommend remaining concerned.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Cynicism protects him from admitting he wanted the sponsorship and liked being wanted by the important people he mocked.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Televised drama is a distraction. Our drama hides at its back.*

2 *The household monument to victory is standing on a secret.*

3 *A scarlet stage has a backstage secret. Check behind its fabric.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I praised the rescue before there was a rescue. Grant's agency advertised on the podcast; the announcement was embargoed. Then I saw the proposed terms. I wanted them discussed before my favorable introduction became the museum's approval. I liked being invited early. There. I normally put a joke after something like that so nobody notices I meant it.

IF MURDERER

I praised the rescue before there was a rescue. Grant's agency paid for advertising. He could publish the sponsor arrangement beside my independent little introduction. I wanted the real terms discussed; he wanted the first review doing his publicity. I liked being invited early. He knew that. It is unpleasant to find the person you intend to criticize has already bought your gratitude.

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I replaced the post with the terms and removed the sponsor credit. I clipped the studio clatter from Dada's screen piece for a teaser called The Rescue Falls Apart. Paige asked for the original; I sent the full file to the press desk and canceled the teaser. I'd made a death sound like good episode timing before there was a death. Now I can't get the title out of my head.

IF MURDERER

I replaced the post with the terms and removed the sponsor credit. The jacket teaser had a clatter under it; Paige got the full export. I took my phone to Grant's private place to show him the revised post. Waiting glass, no Grant. I sat there replaying the old favorable version. He'd kept that one. I could edit mine all night; his screenshot would still exist. Do you know how sick you get of hearing your own voice doing the pitch?

STOP

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Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The sound was the jacket hitting the studio floor. The recipient had its original sound and picture before the gala. I used it for my teaser. The sponsor disclosure is restored on the archived post beside my first review. I can hear myself explaining why that title was clever. I would like that version of me to stop talking.

IF MURDERER

> The sound was Grant collapsing before the toast. I used gala audio beneath the studio jacket footage. His trouble had started before he drank from the gift glass. I made a tasteless teaser. I can hear myself explaining why the title was clever. I would like that version of me to stop talking. But the picture does not establish when my separate audio was recorded.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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BALLOT

Drew Conclusions

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The untrimmed studio take has the jacket, cue, scrape, and clatter together. My teaser borrowed that sound. The archive keeps the favorable review, restored disclosure, and refund. Paige, write what you find. I am not going to help by supplying an amusing description of myself. For once I would like to hear the sentence without improving its ending.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The sound came from the studio take, with the empty jacket. There was no earlier collapse of the donor in my recording. I took poison at the preview and used the unattended glass. Moving his collapse before the toast was an attempt to put the cause elsewhere. The untrimmed production source contradicted me. Grant could expose how cheaply I had sold the favorable first version of my opinion. I thought I could control the story by deciding where it began. It begins with a man dead, and I am the reason he is.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.